

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- At the joint meeting the trustees' Committee on the Conference and the Conference Agenda Committee discussed the idea of having a more flexible agenda for 2002 in case additional topics of concern come up during the year. The Conference Agenda Committee decided to submit two presentation/discussion topics and one workshop topic in order to allow room for additional presentations or reports, if necessary.
- The committee discussed the format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner of the General Service Conference and made no changes.
- The committee discussed the Conference Evaluation Form and suggested changing the heading of Section #4 to Conference Committee Reports and copying the form onto a brighter color in 2002. It was further suggested that the Conference Evaluation Form be kept in the front of the Conference Manual and that announcements be made throughout the Conference week to fill out the form.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and added the following Procedure: "To review the available archives literature."
- The committee reviewed the newly developed Archives Workbook and expressed their appreciation for the work done by the trustees' Archives Committee. Members of the committees also expressed their appreciation to the General Service Office Publications Department for their help to make the item available by this year's Conference.
- The committee considered a request to produce a pamphlet about how archives carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous and encouraged the trustees' Archives Committee to develop a service piece about how archives carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous.



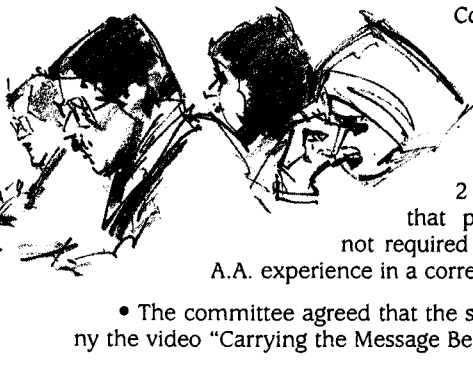
¹ Secondary committee

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee suggested that the word "dental" appear only once in the third sentence of paragraph three (3) in the service piece, "Working with Students Attending Professional Schools" (F-106).
- The committee suggested that the paragraph on page 31 of the C.P.C. Workbook beginning with, "These publications are all listed..." be changed to read, "there are also catalogs for Special Needs and Grapevine materials."
- The committee suggested that the sentence following the heading "Basic Guidelines for C.P.C. Presentations," at the bottom of page 16 in the C.P.C. Workbook, be changed to read: "Here are two *suggested* formats for presentations..." which reflects a suggestion by the 2000 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community.
- The committee suggested that Item F-64, the postal subscription card for *About A.A.*, be added to the contents of the C.P.C. Kit and that item numbers appear with all items listed on the C.P.C. Kit Contents (M-41) sheet.
- The committee forwarded to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities a suggestion that the "Singleness of Purpose" statement outlined in the 1997 Advisory Action be moved to a more prominent place in the C.P.C. pamphlets: "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community," "Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?," "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional," "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Professionals," "If You Are a Professional," and "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous." The committee asked that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities forward ideas and suggestions to the 2002 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community. (Note: The "Singleness of Purpose" statement reads: "Alcoholism and drug addiction are often referred to as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Alcoholics and nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings. But only those with a *drinking* problem may attend closed meetings or become A.A. members. People with problems other than alcoholism are eligible for A.A. membership *only* if they have a drinking problem.")

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the service piece to accompany the video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" and suggested that the following information be included in the section "Take a Meeting into or Share at a Correctional Facility":
 - 1 Sharing that may help to alleviate fears regarding security in a correctional facility.
 - 2 A reference to the fact that previous incarceration is not required to share practical, sober A.A. experience in a correctional facility.
- The committee agreed that the service piece to accompany the video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" should





be added to the Correctional Facilities Kit and placed in the service files at the General Service Office.

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook. Since the Workbook reflects the practical experiences of A.A. members in various service areas, the committee agreed that any future sharing or experience should be forwarded to the Correctional Facilities staff secretary in order for the information in the Workbook to be current.
- The committee discussed various ways to carry the message into youth detention centers and short-term facilities and emphasized the importance of working closely with C.P.C. and P.I. committees to provide information to those professionals who specialize in this type of work. The committee noted there is a need for younger A.A.s to share their experience, strength and hope at these facilities and suggested that increased efforts should be made to communicate this need through young people's groups in Alcoholics Anonymous.
- The committee agreed that communication between local A.A. committees is the key to more effective Bridging the Gap, Prerelease and Temporary Contact efforts.
- The committee shared experience on the value of participating in activities, such as Funshops, area luncheons and service symposiums that facilitate better communication between local service committees that carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic, wherever he or she may be.

FINANCE

- In expectation of continuing discussions of using literature price reductions as the primary mechanism in adjusting the relationship of the Reserve Fund, the committee invites areas to share their views.
- The committee discussed how areas separate and account for local convention activities, including ongoing convention funds. As the input did not create a clear group conscience, we request additional sharing from the Fellowship concerning their convention accounting and reporting practices as they may apply to the International Convention. The committee offered the following points for discussion:

Essentially, the General Service Board has held Convention funds "in trust." They have been held in the Reserve Fund. These funds, deposited with or withdrawn from the Reserve Fund, have impacted the balance of the Fund for the Ample Prudent Reserve calculation.

It has been suggested that if we were to establish an ongoing Convention Fund (which would be essentially the monetary results of the International Conventions held to date), it would be more in keeping with the practices of many parts of the Fellowship.

Balances left in the Fund after a Convention would then be used to help fund the next Convention, instead of having the operating corporation (A.A.W.S.) do so. Currently we are expending funds for two future Conventions and it is conceivable that we may be working three Conventions out at some point.

A suggested minimum "fund balance" could be determined and then the remainder might be used to help defray the registration fee of the next event.

- The committee discussed an area's suggestion "that the 2001 Conference appoint an ad hoc Ways and Means committee to discuss and present to the 2002 Conference their ideas and suggestions on how our General Service Office may become fully self-supporting through A.A. member and group contributions" and felt it was not necessary at this time.
- The committee discussed self-support using tools such as workshops, visual aids, reporting on where the money goes when passing the basket, there is no contribution too small, and the need to communicate and educate.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in the year 2003 or later, and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board its suggestion that the Grapevine produce a softcover anthology of articles that would be helpful to newcomers and which have been previously published in the magazine.



- The committee discussed the need for an announcement card about the A.A. Grapevine that could be distributed to A.A. groups and read at meetings and concluded that there was no need to produce such a card at this time. Understanding the importance of raising awareness of the Grapevine in A.A. groups, the committee suggested that information about subscribing to the magazine be included in some of G.S.O.'s regularly scheduled mailings to listed groups and area committees and in some of the Kits and Workbooks offered by G.S.O.

- The committee discussed the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., refrain from sponsoring or hosting online meetings, including but not limited to real-time meetings, e-mail meetings, bulletin boards, and forums and, after careful consideration, decided that no action was necessary.

- The committee encouraged the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to approach the use of any real-time online format with caution.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee reviewed the trustees' report on the general International Conventions Inventory and agreed there was a good response from the Fellowship, and that, as indicated in the trustees' report, there was an overall positive feeling about A.A. International Conventions; that these events fulfill their purpose; should be self-supporting and should continue. The committee agreed that if a "general International Conventions Inventory" is done in future, a single inventory questionnaire be sent out mid-way between Conventions.

Note: *Introductory Text:* Trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums Report on the General International Convention Inventory dated January 27, 2001:

The 1999 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums implement a general inventory on International Conventions. The trustees' committee presented an interim report to the 2000 Conference Committee and is responsible for presenting a final report to the 2001 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

On June 9, 2000, the International Conventions Coordinator mailed to all Conference members a request for sharing on the general subject of International Conventions with responses due January 1, 2001. Delegates were asked for only one response per area. Two sample questionnaires were enclosed with the mailing.

Of the ninety-three delegate areas, forty areas returned completed questionnaires yielding a 43 % response rate.

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and agreed that thorough communication to the Fellowship by areas, districts and the General Service Office was key to generating interest in Forums. Ideas shared on helping to encourage interest in Forums included:

Early organization of a host committee.

Development of flyers that clearly describe what a Forum is in addition to where and when.

Pre-Forum informational sessions with D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s so they are better able to describe what a Forum is to members.

Early gathering of suggested presentation/workshop topics from area members.

Early mailing by the General Service Office of Preliminary Forum Agenda.

- The committee gratefully expressed their thanks and appreciation to the 2000 Minneapolis International Convention Host Committee for their extraordinary enthusiasm, and hard work in helping to make the Convention a successful and joyous celebration of Alcoholics Anonymous.

LITERATURE

- The committee discussed four different proposals to change the Fourth Edition of the Big Book Conference distribution process and took no action. The committee based this decision on the 1999 Conference Advisory Action which reads, "Based on precedent in regard to previous editions of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the A.A. history book, and *Daily Reflections*, any draft copy of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be considered a work-in-progress, and as such, is confidential; the operating principle being that any story material brought forward to the Conference Literature Committee will be done on a 'for-their-eyes-only' basis adhering to the principle of the 'right of decision,' and not brought forward for any other general distribution until publication."

- In order for the Fellowship to have equal access to information about the 24 new stories and the 16 stories brought forward from the Third Edition of the Big Book and also to give the General Service Office Publications Department adequate time to collect releases from the authors of the new stories, the committee agreed that the personal story section of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book remain confidential until publication. The General Service Office will contact all current and previous subcommittee, trustees' and Conference Literature Committee members after this Conference to request that any material in their possession

¹ Secondary committee

pertaining to the Fourth Edition of the Big Book be returned to the General Service Office. The draft manuscripts of the 1,222 stories originally submitted for consideration for the Fourth Edition Big Book have been held in trust by all involved. This is a customary request to protect the confidentiality of all stories submitted by A.A. members.

- In order to give the General Service Office Publications Department adequate time to collect releases from the authors of the stories in the pamphlets "Can A.A. Help Me Too? — Black/African Americans Share Their Stories" and "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic — Never Too Late," the committee agreed that these pamphlets remain confidential until publication.

- The committee discussed the trustees' Literature Committee's proposal for a new pamphlet that includes a variety of spiritual experience and took no action. The committee suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee consider adding to or clarifying existing pamphlets such as "This Is A.A." and "A Newcomer Asks" to address a variety of individual interpretations and individual experience of spirituality in Alcoholics Anonymous.

The committee suggested that the trustees' P.I. and C.P.C. Committees consider addressing in their literature that A.A. is not allied with any religion.

- The committee discussed the request "that in the future no draft copy of any literature be submitted for approval by the General Service Conference without all Conference members having the opportunity to review that literature" and saw no need for any action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed their Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed to correct paragraph 2 of the "Scope" describing the Admissions function to read, "Is responsible for reviewing all requests for admission to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference."

- The "Application for Additional Delegate Area" was reviewed and the committee agreed on a number of changes to be included in a draft that will be distributed to committee members after the Conference for additional suggestions. A final draft of the "Application for Additional Delegate Area" will be forwarded to the 2002 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee for consideration and implementation.

- The committee agreed on some basic guidelines for the use of Conference members' portable computers during the General Service Conference, if or when a Conference agrees that use of portable computers is appropriate. The basic guidelines will be passed on to the trustees' Committee on the Conference with the request that consideration be given to a trial use of portable computers during the 2002 General Service Conference, if the Conference agrees. The committee also requests that the trustees' Committee on the Conference gather information on costs related to use of portable computers during a General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Nominating Committee's recommendation on Bill W.'s "Memorandum on New Delegates" regarding future growth of the General Service Conference. The committee strongly suggested that the General Service Board gather input from all trustees and delegate areas on current problems within the General Service Conference structure, as well as possible solutions. The General Service Board is

asked to share a progress report and background with the 2002 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee by February 15, 2002.

- The committee discussed a request to consider the use of electronic voting systems during the General Service Conference, and agreed to request that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference explore the spiritual, practical and financial implications of using electronic voting systems during a General Service Conference. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference report their findings by February 15, 2002 to the 2002 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee for further consideration.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee considered a request that a television Public Service Announcement specific to the Holiday Season be produced. Based on a report that indicated that there is less available air-time and increased competition for broadcasting P.S.A.s during this period of the year, the committee felt that it might be more cost effective to look at radio and print vehicles for this Holiday Season concept. The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee examine these options and report back to the 2002 Conference Public Information Committee.

- The committee discussed the concept of utilizing centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of future P.S.A.s, in addition to the work of local committees and found that the concept was worth pursuing. The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee present a complete proposal, including detailed cost estimates and a more precise explanation of the potential benefits to the 2002 Conference Public Information Committee for their consideration.

- The committee discussed the trustees' Public Information Committee's idea of formulating a long range development plan for future P.S.A.s and requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee develop a detailed plan including cost estimates to be forwarded to the 2002 Conference Public Information Committee for their consideration.

- The committee discussed the draft of the proposed trustees' Public Information Committee's policy on the co-founders' posthumous anonymity and expressed appreciation for the sensitivity which the committee demonstrated and the practical manner in which this policy can guide the General Service Office in dealing with the media concerning our co-founders' anonymity.

- The committee reviewed the 2000 and current reports on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site activity and were encouraged by the growing effectiveness of this most valuable P.I. vehicle. Members of the committee emphasized the increasing use of area web sites in communicating local A.A. information to the general public and the Fellowship.

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and noted that changes approved by the 2000 General Service Conference concerning Anonymity at the Level of the Internet had been implemented in several pamphlets and that the remainder of the changes are on schedule to be implemented.

- The committee expressed appreciation for the presence of the two observers from the German General Service Office during their deliberations.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed the suggestion to clarify the procedures for redistricting by adding wording to the effect that "When redistricting, approval of the groups within each district involved is essential and the proposed redistricting plan should be approved by the area assembly" on Pages S30-S31 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, in section titled Redistricting, and took no action. The committee agreed that the current wording on Page S31 reflects the spirit of the Twelve Traditions and is not in conflict with areas that have guidelines.

- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the group structure chart in *The A.A. Service Manual*, Chapter Two: The Group and Its G.S.R. and concluded that because the chapter includes the following sentence, "The pamphlet 'The A.A. Group' provides extensive information on group organization and opportunities for service," and "The A.A. Group" pamphlet includes the group structure chart, it is not necessary to reinstate the group chart in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

- The committee considered the suggestion to restore Appendix A "Original Conference Charter - 1955," Appendix B "1955 Resolution" and Appendix C "Current Conference Charter" to the front of the manual to reflect its placement as it was in the 1999 *A.A. Service Manual*, and reinstate the section titled "What is the Conference Plan" to its original placement as in the 1999 *Service Manual* and took no action.

- The committee discussed the suggestion to change the sentence on Page S63, under #3 "A resume of the candidate, covering professional, business, and A.A. service qualifications...." to read "A resume of the candidate, covering A.A. service, business and professional qualifications...." and unanimously agreed to take no action as all aspects are considered important regardless of the order placed in the text, and changing the order might indicate a priority of qualifications.

- The committee suggested deleting the first sentence in Paragraph #3 on Page S63 under the title "Trustees-at-Large" and replace with "Each trustee-at-large is requested to attend Regional Forums in both the U.S. and Canada. If schedules permit, each trustee-at-large could attend one Regional Forum in each of the eight North American regions over the course of their four-year term."

- The committee considered the suggestion to add a footnote to Page 61 of the *A.A. Service Manual* or to expand the scope of the existing footnote #9, under Concept XI, to reflect current practices and concluded that given the complexity of laws affecting the workplace today, this item be referred to the A.A.W.S. Board for consultation with legal counsel.

- The committee considered the suggestion that a column be added to the group listings in A.A. Directories showing the date group information was last updated and took no action. The committee agreed that adding the last update would not provide better information to the Fellowship.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed collected sharing on formats used for institutional meetings, and considered the two-paragraph state-



ment "Why We Are Here" proposed for inclusion in the Treatment Facilities Kit. After thorough discussion, the sense of the meeting was that there is no need to include this statement as this information is included in the A.A. Preamble and other materials. Many local committees have already developed their own method of presenting this information.

- The committee shared about the activities of local Treatment Facilities Committees, and stressed the importance of ongoing cooperation and communication with the staff of each facility.

The committee also focused on using A.A. literature in carrying the message into short-term and outpatient facilities, where it may not be practical to bring in meetings, with particular emphasis on providing local meeting directories and subscriptions for the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña.

- The committee discussed Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts in their areas, and stressed its importance for alcoholics in making the successful transition from a treatment facility to sobriety in A.A. Many areas have developed effective procedures for implementing Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact programs. Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact workshops have explained this service to local members and helped them become involved. Often working together, area and district service committees and intergroup/central offices have extended the hand of A.A. through Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts.

- The committee considered ways treatment facilities committees can help when it comes to individuals referred to A.A. who focus on problems other than alcohol at A.A. meetings. Committee members shared the experience with this topic in their areas. Some solutions discussed included: continual sharing about our A.A. Traditions with treatment facilities staff, workshops on what A.A. does and does not do, and use of A.A. literature, especially the pamphlet, "Problems Other Than Alcohol." The committee shared that at meetings, individual A.A. members can provide loving but firm one-on-one sharing and sponsorship to newcomers.

- The committee forwarded numerous suggestions for additions and changes to the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook to the trustees' committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities for consideration.

TRUSTEES

- The committee suggested that the trustees' Nominating Committee's *Composition, Scope and Procedure* be included as background material for the members of the Conference Committee on Trustees.

FLOOR ACTION WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- That the proposed draft of the posthumous anonymity policy be made available to this Conference to review and vote on as a general policy of this Fellowship.